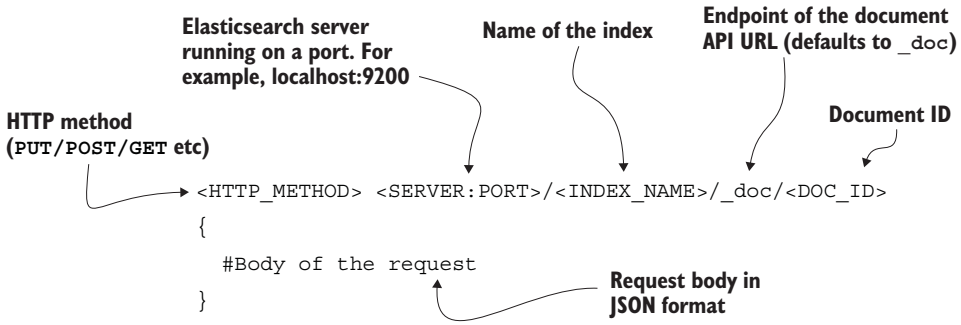


Figure 2.2 Elasticsearch URL invocation endpoint using an HTTP method

The Elasticsearch API accepts a JSON document as the request body, so the book we want to index should accompany this request. For example, the following code block indexes a `book` document with ID 1 to a `books` index.

Listing 2.1 Indexing a `book` document into the `books` index

```
PUT books/_doc/1
{
  "title":"Effective Java",
  "author":"Joshua Bloch",
  "release_date":"2001-06-01",
  "amazon_rating":4.7,
  "best_seller":true,
  "prices": {
    "usd":9.95,
    "gbp":7.95,
    "eur":8.95
  }
}
```

The index is books, and the document ID is 1.

The body of the request consists of JSON data.

It can be a bit overwhelming if you are seeing a request like this for the first time, but trust me—it is not that difficult once you dissect it. The first line is the command that tells Elasticsearch what to do with the request. We say to put the `book` document (which is attached as a body to the request) into an index (imagine an index as a table in a database; it's a collection to hold all `book` documents) called `books`. Finally, the primary key of the book is represented by the ID `1`.

We can also use cURL (if you are not aware of cURL, it's a command-line data transfer tool, usually used to talk to various services exposed on the internet) for the same request to persist the book document into Elasticsearch. This is discussed next.

USING CURL

We can also use cURL to work with Elasticsearch and index our `book` document into our `books` index. Note that we prefer Kibana over cURL in this book, so all the code is